

OECD/AIAS ICTWSS Database

Version 2.0
Codebook

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Foreword

The database on *Institutional Characteristics of Trade Unions, Wage Setting, State Intervention and Social Pacts* (ICTWSS) has been developed by Prof. Jelle Visser at the University of Amsterdam. It was first released in May 2007. The database has been updated since every second or third year and extended to include more variables and countries. In 2021, the ICTWSS database has been rebranded as the OECD/AIAS ICTWSS database. The new name reflects the joint effort by the OECD and AIAS-HSI to ensure the continuation of the database after Prof. Visser's retirement. The OECD/AIAS ICTWSS database develops and consolidates earlier versions of the ICTWSS database, notably in providing more detailed information on minimum wage settings in OECD and expanding geographical coverage to Western Balkan countries.

The first version (1.0) of the OECD/AIAS ICTWSS database has been released in February 2021¹ followed by a slightly revised version (1.1) in April 2023².

This codebook accompanies the release of the version (2.0) of the OECD/AIAS ICTWSS database³. A full update of the database will be available end 2026. The views expressed herein can in no way be taken to reflect the official opinion of the European Union.

¹ The version 1.0 has been produced with the financial assistance of the European Union Programme for Employment and Social Innovation "EaSI" (2014-2020), VS/2019/0185.

² The version 1.1 has been produced with the financial assistance of the ESF+ - Employment and Social Innovation strand (2021-2027) provided under the agreement ref. no. VS/2022/0100

³ The 2.0 version is again produced with the financial assistance of the ESF+ - Employment and Social Innovation strand (2021-2027) provided under the agreement ref. no. VS/2022/0100

The OECD/AIAS ICTWSS database is publicly available at <https://www.oecd.org/en/data/datasets/oecdaias-ictwss-database.html>. The previous versions of the ICTWSS database (1-6.1) can be found at the following page <https://www.ictwss.org/downloads>.

For any information or correction, please contact CollectiveBargaining@oecd.org.

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This document, as well as any data and map included herein, are without prejudice to the status of or sovereignty over any territory, to the delimitation of international frontiers and boundaries and to the name of any territory, city or area.

The statistical data for Israel are supplied by and under the responsibility of the relevant Israeli authorities. The use of such data by the OECD is without prejudice to the status of the Golan Heights, East Jerusalem and Israeli settlements in the West Bank under the terms of international law.

Content and organisation of the database

The ICTWSS database covers two key elements of modern political economies:

- i. the organisation and coordination of collective bargaining, wage setting, and social pacts, and
- ii. the organisation of employers and representation of employees in trade unions and works councils.

The version 2.0 presents annual data between 1960 and 2024 on 55 countries: all current OECD and/or EU members: Australia, Austria, Belgium, Bulgaria, Canada, Chile, Colombia, Costa Rica, Croatia, Cyprus⁴, Czechia, Denmark, Estonia, Germany, Greece, Finland, France, Hungary, Iceland, Ireland, Israel, Italy, Japan, Democratic People's Republic of Korea, Latvia, Lithuania, Luxembourg, Malta, Mexico, Netherlands, New Zealand, Norway, Poland, Portugal, Romania, Spain, Slovak Republic, Slovenia, Sweden, Switzerland, Türkiye, United Kingdom and United States– with some additional data for Peru and the following G20 countries: Argentina, Brazil, India, Indonesia, and South Africa; and EU accession and Balkan countries: Albania, Bosnia and Herzegovina, Kosovo, Montenegro, North Macedonia, and Serbia.

The database contains more than 100 variables, organised in 7 groups:

- A. Rights of association, collective bargaining and strikes, private and public sector;
- B. Wage setting: state intervention, coordination, centralisation, conflict resolution, indexation, extension, derogation, etc.;
- C. Social pacts, central agreements and social dialogue;
- D. Works councils and employee representation in the enterprise;
- E. Employer organisations;

⁴ Note by Turkey: The information in this document with reference to "Cyprus" relates to the southern part of the Island. There is no single authority representing both Turkish and Greek Cypriot people on the Island. Turkey recognises the Turkish Republic of Northern Cyprus (TRNC). Until a lasting and equitable solution is found within the context of the United Nations, Turkey shall preserve its position concerning the "Cyprus issue".

Note by all the European Union Member States of the OECD and the European Union: The Republic of Cyprus is recognised by all members of the United Nations with the exception of Turkey. The information in this document relates to the area under the effective control of the Government of the Republic of Cyprus.

- F. Trade union membership and union density;
- G. Collective bargaining coverage.

OECD Standard list of names of countries

Short name	ISO	Short name	ISO	Short name	ISO
Albania	ALB	Germany	DEU	New Zealand	NZL
Argentina	ARG	Greece	GRC	North Macedonia	MKD
Australia	AUS	Hungary	HUN	Norway	NOR
Austria	AUT	Iceland	ISL	Peru	PER
Belgium	BEL	India	IND	Poland	POL
Bosnia and Herzegovina	BIH	Indonesia	IDN	Portugal	PRT
Brazil	BRA	Ireland	IRL	Romania	ROU
Bulgaria	BGR	Israel ²	ISR	Serbia	SRB
Canada	CAN	Italy	ITA	Slovak Republic	SVK
Chile	CHL	Japan	JPN	Slovenia	SVN
Colombia	COL	Korea	KOR	South Africa	ZAF
Costa Rica	CRI	Kosovo ³	XKV*	Spain	ESP
Croatia	HRV	Latvia	LVA	Sweden	SWE
Cyprus ¹	CYP	Lithuania	LTU	Switzerland	CHE
Czechia	CZE	Luxembourg	LUX	Türkiye	TUR
Denmark	DNK	Malta	MLT	United Kingdom	GBR
Estonia	EST	Mexico	MEX	United States	USA
Finland	FIN	Montenegro	MNE		
France	FRA	Netherlands	NLD		

1. Note by Türkiye: The information in the documents with reference to “Cyprus” relates to the southern part of the Island. There is no single authority representing both Turkish and Greek Cypriot people on the Island. Türkiye recognizes the Turkish Republic of Northern Cyprus (TRNC). Until a lasting and equitable solution is found within the context of the United Nations, Türkiye shall preserve its position concerning the “Cyprus issue”.

Note by all the European Union Member States of the OECD and the European Union: The Republic of Cyprus is recognised by all members of the United Nations with the exception of Türkiye. The information in the documents relates to the area under the effective control of the Government of the Republic of Cyprus.

2. The statistical data for Israel are supplied by and under the responsibility of the relevant Israeli authorities. The use of such data by the OECD is without prejudice to the status of the Golan Heights, East Jerusalem and Israeli settlements in the West Bank under the terms of international law.

3. This designation is without prejudice to positions on status and is in line with United Nations Security Council Resolution 1244/99 and the Advisory Opinion of the International Court of Justice on Kosovo's declaration of independence.

*: Code used for practical reasons and not official ISO code for Kosovo.

Section A. Rights

RA_m: Right of Association, market sector

3 = yes

2 = yes, with minor restrictions

1 = yes, with major restrictions

0 = no

RA_g: Right of Association, government sector

3 = yes

2 = yes, with minor restrictions

1 = yes, with major restrictions

0 = no

RCB_m: Right of Collective bargaining, market sector

3 = yes

2 = yes, with minor restrictions

1 = yes, with major restrictions

0 = no

RCB_g: Right of Collective bargaining, government sector

3 = yes

2 = yes, with minor restrictions

1 = yes, with major restrictions

0 = no

RS_m: Right to Strike, market sector

3 = yes

2 = yes, with minor restrictions

1 = yes, with major restrictions

0 = no

RS_g: Right to Strike, government sector

3 = yes

2 = yes, with minor restrictions

1 = yes, with major restrictions

0 = no

Section B. Wage setting

Minimum wages

Note: The OECD/AIAS ICTWSS database version 2.0 includes new variables that allow to characterise the minimum wage setting mechanisms between 1980 and 2023.

NMW: Is there a statutory minimum wage in the country?

0 = no

1 = yes, but the statutory minimum wage(s) cover(s) only specific sectors, specific groups, occupations and/or regions

2 = yes, at national level

Coding rules: The variable is coded as 2 only when a statutory minimum wage exists at national/federal level. When statutory minimum wages exist only at subnational level or in specific sectors/groups/occupations the variable is coded as 1. The coding is not a function of the share of the workforce but of the level where the statutory minimum wage is fixed.

MW_type: Are there single or differentiated rates (or exemptions) in the country?

-99 = Not applicable (NMW=0)

1 = Single rate

2 = Differentiated rates or exemptions

Coding rules: Sub minimum wage rates (e.g. typically for the youth), geographical/territorial rates (e.g. typically in federal states), and differences across sectors or occupations as well as full exemptions are counted. Differentiations based on standard weekly working hours are NOT counted as differentiation unless they are specifically limited to one sector/occupation.

MW_type_*: Are differentiated by *?

List of differentiations (*):

yngw: young workers

app&trai: apprentices, interns, people in training

secto: sector

geoar: geographic area

other: other differentiation

0 = Not differentiated

1 = Differentiated

2 = Exempt

MW_uprate: How is a change in the minimum wage decided?

1 = rule-based

2 = at the discretion of public institution or the body setting the minimum wage

Coding rules: (1) a form of indexation (to price or other indicators) plays a formal role in the decision to increase the minimum wage. The variable is coded as 1 both when the indexation rule is strict (i.e. the government cannot deviate) as well as when the government, social partners and/or technical bodies retain

some margins of discretion. (2) either there are no indexation criteria or they can be ignored by the public institutions or body setting the MW. In the case of multiple rates, the rate covering most workers is selected.

MW_comm: Is there a committee or body with a clear mandate to adjust the minimum wage?

0 = no

1 = yes, purely advisory

2 = yes, somewhat binding

Coding rules: (0) no such committee exists; (1) a consultative committee exists, but it plays only an advisory role and its advice does not need to be taken into account by legislators; (2) a committee exists and its advice is binding or it can only be ignored under specific circumstances and procedures.

Centralisation and organisation of multi-level bargaining

CA_national: Is a cross-sectoral/national collective agreement in force?

1 = yes

0 = no

CA_sectoral: Is a sectoral collective agreement in force?

1 = yes

0 = no

CA_company: Is a company/plant-level collective agreement in force?

1 = yes

0 = no

CA_subnational: Is a sub-national (region/state specific) collective agreement in force?

1 = yes

0 = no

CA_occupation: Is a profession/occupation-specific collective agreement in force?

1 = yes

0 = no

Level: The predominant level at which wage bargaining takes place (in terms of coverage of employees)

5 = wage bargaining predominantly takes place at the central or cross-industry level

4 = wage bargaining intermediates or alternates between the central and industry level;

3 = wage bargaining predominantly takes place at the sector or industry level;

2 = wage bargaining intermediates or alternates between the sector and enterprise level;

1 = bargaining predominantly takes place at the company or enterprise level.

Multilevel: The combination of levels at which collective bargaining over wages takes place

7 = cross-sectoral (entire economy or private sector), with centrally determined binding norms, minima or ceilings to be respected by all further agreements, which can only implement central agreements

6 = cross-sectoral (entire economy or private sector) and sectoral, with sectoral agreements that specify and can deviate from central agreements, guidelines or targets

5 = cross-sectoral (entire economy or private sector), sectoral and company, with company agreements that specify and can deviate from sector agreements, and sector agreements that specify and can deviate from central agreements

4 = cross-sectoral (entire economy or private sector) and company, with company agreements that specify and can deviate from central agreements

3 = sectoral (separate branches of the economy), with sectorally determined binding norms, minima or ceilings to be respected by all further agreements and company or enterprise agreements that can only implement sector agreements

2 = sectoral (separate branches of the economy) and company, with company agreements that specify and can deviate from sectorally agreed norms, guidelines or targets

1 = company (or units thereof).

rAEB: Reach or incidence of additional enterprise bargaining

3 = additional enterprise bargaining on wages is common: more than half of employees covered by sector or central agreements are affected

2 = additional enterprise bargaining on wages occurs only in large firms: between 10 and 50 percent of employees covered by sector or central agreements are affected

1 = additional enterprise bargaining on wages is rare even in large firms: less than 10 percent of employees covered by sector or central agreements are affected

0 = no additional enterprise-level bargaining on wages; this including cases where such bargaining is explicitly forbidden

Note: Where regional agreements are nested within sector agreements, substituting for additional enterprise bargaining in small firms, this is treated as a functional equivalent and thus counted as additional enterprise bargaining.

Central: centralisation of collective bargaining

Central is a summary index of the degree of centralisation of collective bargaining. Starting with the code for the dominant level of bargaining, *Central* takes three additional elements into account: the incidence of and control over additional bargaining at enterprise level (*rAEB*, rescaled to a 3-level measure so that it is the same as *WSSA* and *OCG* by combining codes 1 and 2); the “space” that central or sectoral agreements assign, delegate or allow for such additional bargaining to take place (*WSSA*); and the degree to which agreements can be perforated through the use of “opening clauses” (*OCG*).

In formal terms:

$$Central = Level - (rAEB*2+WSSA+OCG)/8$$

Art: Articulation of enterprise bargaining

1 = articulated: additional enterprise bargaining on wages is recognized and takes place under control of the 'outside' union, i.e. the signatory or signatories of sector and company agreements come from the same organisation(s) and are bound by the same rules

2 = partially articulated: additional enterprise bargaining on wages takes place under control of the (non-union) works council; the signatory or signatories of sector and company agreements are bound by different rules and control of the 'outside' union is partial

3 = disarticulated bargaining; additional enterprise bargaining on wages when it happens is, formally or informally, also conducted by non-union bodies and not answerable to or under control of the 'outside' union

Note: unless stated otherwise, the focus is on the private sector and on manufacturing.

DR: Derogation from the law

1 = it is possible to derogate from terms established by law (and offer less favourable conditions) by means of collective agreement

0 = it is not possible to derogate from the law

FAV: Favourability

3 = favourability is inversed, terms in lower level agreements take precedence

2 = hierarchy between levels is undefined and a matter for the negotiating parties (not fixed in law).

1 = Lower-level agreements must by law offer more favourable terms, but exceptions possible under defined conditions

0 = Hierarchy between agreement-levels is strictly applied and defined in law: lower-level agreements can only offer more favourable terms

-99 = not applicable (no higher level agreements)

WSSA: Wage setting in sectoral agreements

2 = sectoral agreements set the framework or define the default for enterprise bargaining

1 = sectoral agreements define the minimum wage level (and minimum rate changes)

0 = sectoral agreements define the minimum and actual levels (and rate changes) of wages

-99 = not applicable

OCG: Opening clauses in sectoral collective agreements.

2 = sectoral agreements contain opening clauses, allowing the renegotiation of contractual wages at enterprise level

1 = sectoral agreements contain opening clauses, allowing the renegotiation of contractual non-wage issues (working hours, working time schedules, unsocial hours, etc.) at enterprise level

0 = sectoral agreements contain no opening clauses

-99 = not applicable (no sectoral agreements)

OCT: Crisis-related, temporary opening clauses in collective agreement

1 = agreements (at any level) contain crisis-related opening clauses, defined as temporary changes, renegotiation or suspension of contractual provisions, under defined hardship conditions

0 = agreements contain no opening clauses

Index: general price indexation or cost-of-living clauses in agreements

1 = (most or many) collective agreements contain (semi-) automatic index or cost-of living escalator clauses, linking wages to prices.

0 = use of index clauses is rare or forbidden

Ext: Mandatory extension of collective agreements to non-organised employers (or a functional equivalent)

3 = extension is virtually automatic and more or less general (including enlargement)

2 = extension is used in many industries, but there are thresholds and Ministers can (and sometimes do) decide not to extend (clauses in) collective agreements

1 = extension is rather exceptional, used in some industries only, because of absence of sector agreements, very high thresholds (supermajorities of 60% or more, public policy criteria, etc.), and/or veto powers of employers

0 = there are neither legal provisions for mandatory extension, nor is there a functional equivalent.

-99 = not applicable (no sectoral agreements)

Length: Length or duration of collective (wage) agreements

(1- ∞) average length of (wage clauses in) collective agreements, in months.

Coordination and government intervention

Coord: Coordination of wage-setting

5 = *Binding norms* regarding maximum or minimum wage rates or wage increases issued as a result of a) centralized bargaining by the central union and employers' associations, with or without government involvement, or b) unilateral government imposition of wage schedule/freeze, with or without prior consultation and negotiations with unions and/or employers' associations.

4 = *Non-binding norms and/or guidelines* (recommendations on maximum or minimum wage rates or wage increases) issued by a) the government or government agency, and/or the central union and employers' associations (acting together or alone), or b) resulting from an extensive, regularized pattern setting coupled with high degree of union concentration and authority.

3 = *Procedural negotiation guidelines* (recommendations on, for instance, wage demand formula relating to productivity or inflation) issued by a) the government or government agency, and/or the central union and employers' associations (together or alone), or based on arbitration awards, or b) resulting from a not yet regularized pattern setting coupled with a medium degree of union concentration and authority.

2 = *Some coordination* of wage setting, based on pattern setting by major companies, sectors, government wage policies in the public sector, judicial awards, or minimum wage policies.

1 = *Fragmented wage bargaining*, confined largely to individual firms or plants, no coordination

Type: Type of coordination of wage setting

- 6 = Government-imposed bargaining (incl. statutory controls in lieu of bargaining)
- 5 = Government-sponsored bargaining (this includes social pacts, provided they deal with wages)
- 4 = Inter-associational by peak associations
- 3 = Intra-associational (“informal centralisation”)
- 2 = Pattern bargaining
- 1 = Government sets signals (public sector wages, minimum wage).
- 0 = No specific mechanism identified

Govint: Government intervention in wage bargaining

- 5 = the government imposes private sector wage settlements, places a ceiling on bargaining outcomes or suspends bargaining;
- 4 = the government participates directly in wage bargaining (tripartite bargaining, as in social pacts);
- 3 = the government influences wage bargaining outcomes indirectly through price-ceilings, indexation, tax measures, minimum wages, and/or pattern setting through public sector wages;
- 2 = the government influences wage bargaining by providing an institutional framework of consultation and information exchange, by conditional agreement to extend private sector agreements, and/or by providing a conflict resolution mechanism which links the settlement of disputes across the economy and/or allows the intervention of state arbitrators or Parliament;
- 1 = none of the above.

Conflict resolution and enforcement of agreements

Peace: Do collective agreements imply a peace obligation and/or typically include a peace clause?

- 2 = strikes may not be called over the terms of the collective agreement while the agreement is in force (which implies a peace clause)
- 1 = there is no (implicit or explicit) legal obligation, but in practice most (private sector) collective agreements contain a peace clause
- 0 = no peace obligation or peace clause

CoR: Conflicts of Rights: Do collective agreements typically include a mediation or arbitration procedure for handling grievances?

- 2 = yes, obligatory
- 1 = yes, voluntarily
- 0 = no or very rare.

Col: Conflicts of Interests: Are arbitration or mediation procedures used in case of conflicts of interest (over new agreements or renewal and change of existing or expired collective agreements)?

2 = yes, obligatory

1 = yes, voluntarily

0 = no or very rare.

Section C. Social pacts and agreements

SPA_negot: A social pact or central agreement is (publicly) being proposed by one of the parties and negotiations do take place in specified year

0 = No

1 = Yes

(Only 'yes' when negotiations have actually taken place; just a proposal by one of the parties is not enough)

SPA_Sign: A social pact or central agreement is signed in specified year

0 = No

1 = Yes (refers to the year in which the pact or agreement is signed, which needs not be the year in which the pact or agreement is applied)

(If more than one pact or agreement is signed in a given year, only one—the most important one in terms of content—is entered).

SPA_Comp: The composition of the signing parties of the pact is as follows:

-99 = No pact or agreement (SPA_Sign=0)

1 = Tripartite agreement: signed by the government and all (mainstream) union confederations and employers' peak associations

2 = Tripartite agreement, without one or more major union confederation(s)

3 = Tripartite agreement, without one or more major employers peak association(s).

4 = Tripartite (minority) agreement, without one or more major union confederation(s) and without one or more major employers' peak association(s).

5 = Bipartite agreement, signed by all major (mainstream) union confederations and employers' peak associations

6 = Bipartite agreement, without one or more major union confederation(s)

7 = Bipartite agreement, without one or more major employers' peak association(s)

8 = Bipartite (minority) agreement, without one or more major union confederations and without one or more major employers' peak federations

9 = Imposed or commuted by the government

(Refers to the pact or agreement coded in SPA_Sign in case of more than one pact or agreement)

Wage_Proc: Pact or agreement sets rules for wage setting (e.g., articulation of bargaining levels, indexation, opening clauses, conflict mediation, renewal of agreements, etc.)

0 = No

1 = Yes (to be registered in year in which pact or agreement is signed)

-99 = not applicable (no social pact or central agreement)

Wage_Min: Pact or agreement sets a substantive norm regarding the minimum level or change of wages

0 = No

1 = Yes (to be registered in year in which pact or agreement is signed)

-99 = not applicable (no social pact or central agreement)

Wage_Max: Pact or agreement sets a substantive norm or ceiling regarding maximum level or change of wages

0 = No

1 = Yes (to be registered in year in which pact or agreement is signed)

-99 = not applicable (no social pact or central agreement)

Tax_Budget: Pact or agreement contains, and/or is predicated on, concessions (or promises) regarding taxation and/or budget decisions

0 = No

1 = Yes (to be registered in year in which pact or agreement is signed)

-99 = not applicable (no social pact or central agreement)

Work_Hrs: Pact or agreement contains, and/or is predicated on, concessions (or promises) regarding working hours

0 = No

1 = Yes (to be registered in year in which pact or agreement is signed)

-99 = not applicable (no social pact or central agreement)

Empl_Pol: Pact or agreement contains, and/or is predicated on, concessions (or promises) regarding employment policies (job creation, subsidies, etc.)

0 = No

1 = Yes (to be registered in year in which pact or agreement is signed)

-99 = not applicable (no social pact or central agreement)

Empl_Leg: Pact or agreement contains, and/or is predicated on, concessions (or promises) regarding employment protection legislation (employment law)

0 = No

1 =Yes (to be registered in year in which pact or agreement is signed)

-99 = not applicable (no social pact or central agreement)

Soc_Sec: Pact or agreement contains, and/or is predicated on, concessions (or promises) regarding social security (unemployment, sickness, disability, family or children allowances)

0 = No

1 = Yes (to be registered in year in which pact or agreement is signed)

-99 = not applicable (no social pact or central agreement)

Pensions: Pact or agreement contains, and/or is predicated on, concessions (or promises) regarding (old age and/or pre-retirement) pensions

0 = No

1 = Yes (to be registered in year in which pact or agreement is signed)

-99 = not applicable (no social pact or central agreement)

Training: Pact or agreement contains, and/or is predicated on, concessions (or promises) regarding vocational training

0 = No

1 = Yes (to be registered in year in which pact or agreement is signed)

-99 = not applicable (no social pact or central agreement)

Union_rights: Pact or agreement contains, and/or is predicated on, concessions (or promises) regarding union representation or union recognition, including employee representation, works councils, bargaining rights, etc.

0 = No

1 =Yes (to be registered in year in which pact or agreement is signed)

-99 = not applicable (no social pact or central agreement)

Concert: Pact or agreement sets up or changes the nation-wide council for social dialogue or 'concertation'.

0 = No

1 =Yes (to be registered in year in which pact or agreement is signed)

-99 = not applicable (no social pact or central agreement)

TC: Existence of a tripartite council for the purpose of negotiation, consultation or information exchange over social and economic policies

2 = tripartite council with representation from the trade unions, employers' associations, and independent experts or government (-appointed) representatives;

1 = council with various societal interest representatives, including unions and employers;

0 = no permanent council.

BC: Existence of a bipartite council of central or major union and employers organisations for the purposes of wage setting, economic forecasting and/or conflict settlement.

1 = yes

0 = no

Section D. Works councils and employee representation in the enterprise

WC: status of works council

2 = existence and rights of works council or structure for (union and non-union based) employee representation within firms or establishments confronting management are mandated by law or established through basic general agreement between unions and employers;

1 = works councils (etc.) are voluntary, i.e. even where they are mandated by law, there are no legal sanctions for non-observance

0 = works council or similar (union or non-union) based institutions of employee representation confronting management do not exist or are exceptional.

WC_type: type of works council

2 = works councils is composed of employees (employee-only council)

1 = works councils is composed of employees and employer (or employer representative), or chaired by (or on behalf of) employers (joint council)

0 = works council does not exist or is most exceptional.

WC_struct: structure of works council representation

3 = single-channel works councils, union-based representation, elected by union members or established by union, based on law or national agreement

2 = dual-channel works councils, union dominated representation, elected by union and non-union members, based on law or national agreement

1 = split-channel works councils, employee elected works councils are mandatory where there is no or insufficient union representation, as a structure supplementary to the union, based on law or national agreement

-99 = not applicable (no works councils)

WC_rights: rights of works councils or employee representatives

3 = economic and social rights, including codetermination on some issues (e.g., mergers, take-overs, restructuring, etc.)

2 = economic and social rights, consultation (advice, with possibility of judicial redress)

1 = information and consultation rights (without judicial redress)

0 = works council or similar (union or non-union) based institutions of employee representation confronting management do not exist or are exceptional.

WC_negot: involvement of works councils (or similar structures) in wage negotiations

4 = works councils (or mandated representatives) formally negotiate (plant-level) collective agreements, alongside or instead of trade unions.

3 = works councils (or mandated representatives) formally negotiate (plant-level) collective agreements, if no union is present (and/or subject to ballot)

2 = works councils is formally (by law or agreement) barred from negotiating (plant-level) agreements, but informally negotiate over workplace-related working conditions or 'employment pacts', including pay

1 = works councils is formally (by law or agreement) barred from negotiating (plant-level) agreements and involvement of works councils in negotiating (plant-level) agreements is rare.

-99 = not applicable (no works councils)

UWRep: Do companies have a union workplace representation separate from works council?

0 = no or exceptional

1 = yes, but only in companies/establishments where unions are recognised and have negotiated a collective agreement

2 = yes, this is mandatory or guaranteed under a basic general agreement between unions and employers

Section E. Employer organisations

NECFs: Number of Employer Confederations (Organisations)

Number of employer confederations (organisations in agriculture are excluded). As a rule, this indicator refers only to employer organisations (excluding those whose sole purpose is to defend the product-market interests of their members) representing at least 5% of employees in firms organised in employer organisations in a particular country. Where this information is unavailable, employer organisations that are members of the main tripartite (or bipartite) institutions regulating collective bargaining at sectoral or national level.

NECFs_private: Number of Employer Confederations (Organisations) in the private sector

Number of employer confederations (organisations in agriculture are excluded) in the private sector. As a rule, this indicator refers only to private sector employer organisations (excluding those whose sole purpose is to defend the product-market interests of their members) representing at least 5% of employees in firms organised in employer organisations in a particular country. Where this information is unavailable, employer organisations that are members of the main tripartite (or bipartite) institutions regulating collective bargaining at sectoral or national level.

ED_private: Employer organisation density in the private sector, as a proportion of employees in the private sector.

Employees in private sector establishments organised in employer organisations as a percentage of all private sector employees.

ED: Employer organisation density, as a proportion of employees

*Employees in establishments organised in employer organisations as a proportion of all employees. This indicator is calculated as the weighted sum of **ED_private** and employment in the government sector, assuming a 100% employment density in the government sector, based on state agencies and, in many countries, associations of local and regional government. Employment in the government sector is taken*

as general government employment from the national accounts. Publicly owned establishments in energy, transport, and communication (Post, Telecom, railways, etc.) are treated as private sector firms, and are usually member of the main (private sector) employer organisations.

Section F. Trade union membership and union density

NTUs: Number of individual Trade Unions

Number of individual trade unions as registered in official registers or estimated sum of individual trade union as published by trade union confederations.

NUCFs: Number of Union Confederations

Number of confederations (very small confederations are ignored and counted as part of the independent, autonomous, or unaffiliated union membership). As a general rule, this indicator refers only to peak-level trade (labour) union organisations (e.g. at cross-sectoral or sectoral level) that have affiliate unions and membership that exceeds 5% of total union membership at national level, or in case this information is not available, union confederations that are members of the main tripartite (or bipartite) institution regulating collective bargaining at sectoral, cross-sectoral or national level).

Unionisation indicators based on the first method (i.e. based on survey data), include:

NUM_s: Net trade (labour) Union Membership

Number of employees who are member of a trade union in their main job as derived from labour force surveys asking to employees about their union membership.

UD_s: Trade Union density

Proportion of employees who are member of a trade union in their main job among all employees as derived from surveys asking to employees about their union membership.

Union densities (**UD_s**) are also available according to employee characteristics: gender, age group,⁵ sector (private or public),⁶ type of contract (part-time or full-time),⁷ and contract duration (temporary or permanent),⁸ as well as the proportion of each group among unionised employees (**UM_s**). These employment characteristics generally comply with the definition used by the OECD in its Employment Database.

Unionisation indicators based on the second method (i.e. based on the compilation of trade union membership statistics), include:

⁵ The database includes two age groups: 15-24, 25-54, 55-64, and 65 and over; or 15-29, 30-49, 50-64, and 65 and over. In instances where the number of observations supporting the estimates is inadequate to generate reliable indicators, the second set of age groups is utilised. Otherwise, and to the extent possible, the option of unionisation according to age groups should be available for both sets.

⁶ It should be noted that, as far as possible, employees working in publicly owned enterprises have been classified as private sector employees in order to restrict the public sector to general government employees consistent with the definition of the national accounts.

⁷ As far as possible, the definition of a part-time job corresponds to the harmonised OECD definition (less than 30-usual weekly hours of work in the main job) published on the OECD data explorer ([OECD Data Explorer • Full-time and part-time employment](#)).

⁸ The definition of temporary employment is consistent with the definition used by the OECD in its Employment Database. For further details, see Table 3 of Labour Force Statistics in [OECD countries: Sources, coverage and Definitions](#).

TUM: Total Union Membership

Total sum of trade (labour) union members (including self-employed workers and non-active union members, i.e., students, retirees or unemployed) at national level.

TUM_excl: Total Union Membership of non-salaried workers as a percentage of total union membership

Trade union members not in the scope of the OECD/AIAS ICTWSS database (self-employed workers and non-active union members, i.e., students, retirees or unemployed) and other adjustments (non-paying members).

NUM: Net trade (labour) Union Membership

Trade (labour) union membership of employees derived for the total (labour) union membership (TUM) and adjusted, if necessary, for trade (labour) union members outside the active dependent, and employed labour force (i.e., retired workers, self-employed workers, students, unemployed), estimated as: $NUM = TUM \times (1 - TUM_excl/100)$

SAL: Total number of employees (in thousands) working in a particular country (domestic concept) according to the International Classification of Status in Employment (ICSE-93).

Total number of employees (in thousands) working in an establishment operating in a particular country (domestic concept) and de facto covered by the national legislation and regulations on social dialogue and collective bargaining. In general, this indicator is based on the number of employees from the OECD Annual National Accounts Database or, where domestic employment statistics are not available, from the OECD Annual Labour Force Statistics or the national Labour Force Statistics.

SAL_female (SAL_male): Total number of female (male) employees (in thousands) working in a particular country (domestic concept) according to the International Classification of Status in Employment (ICSE-93).

These series are based on the total number of employees (SAL) for which the proportion of males (females) in the salaried employment from labour force surveys is applied.

SAL_public (SAL_private): Total number of public-(private-) sector employees (in thousands) working in a particular country (domestic concept) according to the International Classification of Status in Employment (ICSE-93).

The number of public-sector employees is derived from general government employment from the OECD Annual National Accounts Database or, where unavailable, from national Labour Force Statistics or national statistics on the public sector based on administrative records. The number of private sector employees is generally derived from total number of employees and the number of public-sector employees ($SAL_private = SAL - SAL_public$). Employees in publicly owned enterprises are included in the private sector.

UD: Trade Union density

Proportion of employees who are member of a trade union as a percentage of the total number of employees, estimated as: $UD = NUM / SAL \times 100$

Union densities (**UD**) based on “administrative” data sources are also available, where possible, according to gender and sector (private or public).

Finally, the overall union density, as well as those by gender and sector (public and private) from both estimation methods (or only one, depending on country) are combined to assess the long-term trend of unionisation.

UD_hist: Historical trend in trade union density.

Indicator combining administrative and/or survey data and describing the historical trend in trade union density based on UD and/or UD_s. Please refer to the Country Notes for further details and information on the underlying series used.

Overall trade union membership and union density by data source

Indicators derived from trade unions' annual returns or derived from statistics based on trade union registrar ("Administrative data")		Indicators based on (household) Labour Force Survey, Social Survey or employer/company survey ("Survey data")	
TUM Total Union Membership	Total sum of trade (labour) union members (including self-employed workers and non-active union members, i.e., students, retirees or unemployed) at national level.	Not applicable	
TUM_excl Total Union Membership of non-salaried workers as a percentage of total union membership	Trade union members not in the scope of the OECD/AIAS ICTWSS database (self-employed workers and non-active union members, i.e., students, retirees or unemployed) and other adjustments (non-paying members). Indicator not published in the OECD/AIAS ICTWSS database.	Not applicable	
NUM Net trade (labour) Union Membership	Trade (labour) union membership of employees derived for the total (labour) union membership (TUM) and adjusted, if necessary, for trade (labour) union members outside the active dependent, and employed labour force (i.e., retired workers, self-employed workers, students, unemployed), estimated as: $NUM = TUM - TUM_excl$	NUM_s Net trade (labour) Union Membership	Number of employees who are member of a trade union in their main job as derived from labour force surveys asking to employees about their union membership.
UD Trade Union density	Proportion of employees who are member of a trade union as a percentage of the total number of employees, estimated as: $UD = NUM / SAL * 100$	UD_s Trade Union density	Proportion of employees who are member of a trade union in their main job among all employees as derived from surveys asking to employees about their union membership.
UD_hist Historical trend in trade union density.	Variable combining administrative and/or survey data and describing the historical trend in trade union density based on UD and UD_s. Please refer to the methodological note for further details and information on the underlying series used.		

Trade union membership and union density by gender by data source

Indicators derived from trade unions' annual returns or derived from statistics based on trade union registrar ("Administrative data")	Indicators based on (household) Labour Force Survey, Social Survey or employer/company survey ("Survey data")
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UM_female Percentage share of female union members	Incidence of women among total union membership of employees, estimated as: $UM_female = NUM_female / NUM * 100$	UM_female_s Percentage share of female union members	Incidence of women among total union membership of employees as derived surveys asking to respondent about their union membership in main job
UD_female Union density rate of females	Proportion of female employees who are member of a trade union among all female employees, estimated as: $UD_female = NUM_female / SAL_female * 100$	UD_female_s Union density rate of females	Proportion of female employees who are member of a trade union in their main job among female employees as derived from surveys asking to employees about their union membership.
UD_male Union density rate of males	Proportion of male employees who are member of a trade union among all male employees, estimated as: $UD_male = NUM_male / SAL_male * 100$	UD_male_s Union density rate of males	Proportion of male employees who are member of a trade union in their main job among male employees as derived from surveys asking to employees about their union membership.

Trade union membership and union density by sector by data source

Indicators derived from trade unions' annual returns or derived from statistics based on trade union registrar ("Administrative data")		Indicators based on (household) Labour Force Survey, Social Survey or employer/company survey ("Survey data")	
UM_public Percentage share of union members in the public sector	Incidence of public-sector employees among total union membership of employees, estimated as: $UM_public = NUM_public / NUM * 100$	UM_public_s Percentage share of union members in the public sector	Incidence of public-sector employees among total union membership of employees as derived surveys asking to respondent about their union membership in main job
UD_public Union density rate of public sector employees	Union density rate of public sector workers, estimated as: $UD_public = NUM_public / SAL_public * 100$	UD_public_s Union density rate of public sector employees	Proportion of public-sector employees who are member of a trade union in their main job among public-sector employees as derived from surveys asking to employees about their union membership.
UD_private Union density rate of private sector employees	Union density rate of private sector worker, estimated as: $UD_private = NUM_private / SAL_private * 100$	UD_private_s Union density rate of private sector employees	Proportion of private sector employees who are member of a trade union in their main job among private sector employees as derived from surveys asking to employees about their union membership.

Unionisation indicators are also available for three additional dimensions (type of contract, contract duration, and age groups) but only based on estimates derived from so-called survey data. As for the previous indicators in this section, for each dimension, the incidence of union membership (**UM_s**) for the group indicated and its union density (**UD_s**) are published.

Trade union membership and union density by type of contract, i.e. part-time vs full-time job ("Survey data")

As far as possible, the definition of a part-time job corresponds to the harmonised OECD definition (less than 30-usual weekly hours of work in the main job) published on the OECD data explorer ([OECD Data Explorer • Full-time and part-time employment](#)).

Indicator	Definition
UM_parttime_s Percentage share of union members working part-time (less than 30-usual weekly hours of work in the main job)	Incidence of employees working part-time (less than 30-usual weekly hours of work in the main job) among total union membership of employees as derived surveys asking to respondent about their union membership in main job
UD_parttime_s Union density rate of employees working part-time (less than 30-usual weekly hours of work in the main job)	Proportion of part-time employees who are member of a trade union in their main job among part-time employees as derived from surveys asking to employees about their union membership.
UD_fulltime_s	Proportion of full-time employees who are member of a trade union in their

Union density rate of employees working full-time (30-usual weekly hours of work or more in the main job)	main job among full-time employees as derived from surveys asking to employees about their union membership.
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Trade union membership and union density by contract duration i.e. temporary vs permanent contracts (“Survey data”)

The definition of temporary employment is consistent with the definition used by the OECD in its Employment Database. For further details, see Table 3 of Labour Force Statistics in [OECD countries: Sources, coverage and Definitions](#).

Indicator	Definition
UM_temp_s Percentage share of union members of employees with a temporary contract (OECD definition)	Incidence of employees with a temporary contract among total union membership of employees as derived surveys asking to respondent about their union membership in main job
UD_temp_s Union density rate of employees with a temporary contract (OECD definition)	Proportion of employees with a temporary contract who are member of a trade union in their main job among employees with a temporary contract as derived from surveys asking to employees about their union membership.
UD_perm_s Union density rate of employees working full-time (30-usual weekly hours of work or more in the main job)	Proportion of male employees who are member of a trade union in their main job among full-time employees as derived from surveys asking to employees about their union membership.

Trade union membership and union density by age groups (“Survey data”)

Youth	Adults	Older workers	Elderly
UM_age1524_s Percentage share of union members aged 15-24.	UM_age2554_s Percentage share of union members aged 25-54.	UM_age5564_s Percentage share of union members aged 55-64.	UM_ageGE65_s Percentage share of union members aged 65 or more.
UD_age1524_s Union density rate of employees aged 15-24.	UD_age2554_s Union density rate of employees aged 25-54.	UD_age5564_s Union density rate of employees aged 55-64.	UD_ageGE65_s Union density rate of employees aged 65 or more.
UM_age1529_s Percentage share of union members aged 15-29.	UM_age3049_s Percentage share of union members aged 30-49.	UM_age5064_s Percentage share of union members aged 50-64.	UM_ageGE65_s Percentage share of union members aged 65 or more.
UD_age1529_s Union density rate of employees aged 15-29.	UD_age3049_s Union density rate of employees aged 30-49.	UD_age5064_s Union density rate of employees aged 50-64.	UD_ageGE65_s Union density rate of employees aged 65 or more.

Section G. Collective bargaining coverage

Note: Collective bargaining coverage represents the share of employees covered by valid collective agreements in force. What counts as a valid collective agreement in force is defined by international and national legislations and, in some case, tribunals.

Someone is covered when, in the reference period, a collective agreement applies to that person's job and regulates his or her employment relation. In most labour laws that means that clauses in the individual employment contract which violate the stipulations the collective agreement are null and void. The target of the bargaining coverage statistic is to record all valid collective agreements during the reference period under consideration and all persons (or jobs) to whom such agreements apply. This includes multi-year agreements which originate from an earlier year but are still valid.

Collective bargaining coverage refers to the formal application of a collective agreement. Therefore, employees covered as the result of administrative extension of the agreement to non-organised firms are

included, even if they work in a company that has not signed it. In contrast, those workers whose wages and/or working conditions are affected by the results of collective bargaining because of spill overs or of non-organised firms that “orientate” their pay policies to the norms defined in collective agreements are not included.

In the framework of the OECD/AIAS ICTWSS database, it is important to note that:

- Given that employees may be covered by several collective agreements (at national, industry, company, or plant level), to avoid double counting, bargaining coverage is defined, not as the number of employees per agreement, but as the number of employees covered by any kind of collective agreement signed by bona fide trade unions.
- Collective agreements at national level fixing the minimum wage (such as those currently negotiated in Belgium or Estonia) are not considered in the calculation of collective bargaining coverage as this would affect the comparability across countries as well as the spirit of the indicator itself (which is about more general bargaining and not the minimum wage).
- Only agreements negotiated by independent representation, i.e. bona fide trade unions, are considered. However, at this stage, the data available do not allow to fully rule out that, in very few instances, the data might also include some agreements negotiated by non-union bodies. But the problem, if confirmed, would be small and not such to put in question the comparability of the estimates.
- Coverage also includes agreements that have expired when the “after effect” of the prior agreement is recognised in law and/or by the social partners.

The definition of collective bargaining coverage used in the Directive (EU) 2022/2041 of the European Parliament and of the Council of 19 October 2022 on adequate minimum wages in the European Union corresponds to the one used to calculate adjusted bargaining coverage (**AdjCov**) in the OECD/AIAS ICTWSS database:

“Collective bargaining coverage’ means the share of workers at national level to whom a collective agreement applies, calculated as the ratio of the number of workers covered by collective agreements to the number of workers whose working conditions may be regulated by collective agreements in accordance with national law and practice.”

Employees with or without the right to collectively bargain

Wstat: Proportion of employees (in % of all employees) covered by statutory regulation and/or excluded from collective bargaining as stated by law or national regulations.

Wage and salary workers who are barred from bargaining but not covered by another instrument (in the United States, for instance, managers and executives in the private sector are legally excluded from collective bargaining through union representation) are still accounted for in the denominator of adjusted bargaining coverage. In general, the groups covered by statutory regulation and excluded from collective bargaining as stated by law or national regulations are civil servants and public sector employees or specific categories of public sector employees (police, armed forces, teachers in some countries).

SALRCB: Number of employees (in thousands) with the right to collectively bargain.

Number of eligible employees (i.e., the total number of employees minus the number of employees legally excluded from the right to collectively bargain), estimated as follows: $SALRCB = SAL \times (1 - (Wstat/100))$

Coverage of collective agreements concluded in a particular year

NCBs_new: Number of newly or renewed collective agreements resulting from collective bargaining between bona fide trade unions and employers or its representative organisation negotiated in a particular year. This indicator is then decomposed (where possible or relevant) into the two following subcomponents:

- **NCBs_new_firm:** Number of newly or renewed collective agreements resulting from collective bargaining between bona fide trade unions and employers or its representative organisation negotiated in a particular year at the enterprise level.
- **NCBs_new_high:** Number of newly or renewed collective agreements resulting from collective bargaining between bona fide trade unions and employers or its representative organisation negotiated in a particular year at higher level.

CB_new: Number of employees (in thousands) covered by any kind of newly or renewed collective agreements resulting from collective bargaining between bona fide trade unions and employers or its representative organisation negotiated in a particular year.

UnadjCB_new: Unadjusted collective bargaining coverage rate of newly or renewed collective agreements.

Number of employees (in thousands) covered by any kind of new collective agreements concluded or renewed in a particular year, as a percentage of the total number of employees, estimated as follows: $UnadjCov_new = Cov_new / SAL \times 100$

AdjCB_new: Adjusted collective bargaining coverage rate of newly or renewed collective agreements.

Number of employees (in thousands) covered by any kind of new collective agreements concluded or renewed in a particular year, as a percentage of employees with the right to collectively bargain, i.e. excluding those covered by statutory regulation and/or excluded from collective bargaining as stated by law or national regulations, as a percentage of employees (in thousands) with the right to collectively bargain and covered by the national legislation on collective bargaining (including those covered by administrative extension and its functional equivalent), estimated as follows: $AdjCov_new = Cov_new / SALRCB \times 100$

Coverage of any kind collective agreements in force

NCBs: Number of collective agreements in force resulting from collective bargaining between bona fide trade unions and employers or its representative organisation and/or resulting from an administrative

extension (or a functional equivalent). This indicator is then decomposed (where possible or relevant) into the two following subcomponents:

- **NCBs_firm**: Number of collective agreements in force resulting from collective bargaining between bona fide trade unions and employers or its representative organisation at the enterprise level.
- **NCBs_high**: Number of collective agreements in force resulting from collective bargaining between bona fide trade unions and employers or its representative organisation at higher level.

Cov: Number of employees (in thousands) covered by any kind of collective agreement in force resulting from collective bargaining between bona fide trade unions and employers or its representative organisation and/or resulting from an administrative extension (or a functional equivalent). This indicator is then decomposed (where possible or relevant) into the two following subcomponents:

- **Cov_CB**: Number of employees (in thousands) covered by any kind of collective agreement in force resulting from collective bargaining between bona fide trade unions and employers or its representative organisation.
- **Cov_ExtE**: Number of employees (in thousands) covered by any kind of collective agreement in force resulting from an administrative extension (or a functional equivalent).

These three indicators are then expressed in percentage, either on the total number of employees (unadjusted coverage rate), or on the number of employees with the right to collectively bargain and covered by the national legislation on collective bargaining.

UnadjCov: Unadjusted collective bargaining coverage rate including any kind of collective agreement in force resulting from collective bargaining between bona fide trade unions and employers or its representative organisation and/or resulting from an administrative extension (or a functional equivalent).

Number of employees (in thousands) covered by collective agreements in force resulting from collective bargaining between bona fide trade unions and employers or its representative organisation and/or resulting from an administrative extension (or a functional equivalent), as a percentage of the total number of employees, estimated as follows: $UnadjCov = Cov / SAL \times 100$

Which is decomposed (where possible or relevant) into:

- **UnadjCov_CB**: Unadjusted collective bargaining coverage rate of any kind of collective agreement in force resulting from collective bargaining between bona fide trade unions and employers or its representative organisation.

Number of employees (in thousands) covered by collective agreements in force resulting from collective bargaining between bona fide trade unions and employers or its representative organisation, as a percentage of the total number of employees, estimated as follows: $UnadjCov_CB = Cov_CB / SAL \times 100$

- **UnadjCov_ExtE**: Unadjusted collective bargaining coverage rate resulting from an administrative extension of existing collective agreement in force (or a functional equivalent).

Number of employees (in thousands) covered by an administrative extension of existing collective agreement in force (or a functional equivalent), as a percentage of the total number of employees, estimated as follows: $UnadjCov_ExtE = Cov_ExtE / SAL \times 100$

AdjCov: Adjusted collective bargaining coverage rate including any kind of collective agreement in force resulting from collective bargaining between bona fide trade unions and employers or its representative organisation and/or resulting from an administrative extension (or a functional equivalent).

Number of employees (in thousands) covered by collective agreements in force resulting from collective bargaining between bona fide trade unions and employers or its representative organisation and/or

resulting from an administrative extension (or a functional equivalent), as a percentage of employees (in thousands) with the right to collectively bargain and covered by the national legislation on collective bargaining, estimated as follows: $\text{AdjCov} = \text{Cov} / \text{SALRCB} \times 100$

Which is decomposed (where possible or relevant) into:

- **AdjCov_CB**: Adjusted collective bargaining coverage rate of any kind of collective agreement in force resulting from collective bargaining between bona fide trade unions and employers or its representative organisation.

Number of employees (in thousands) covered by collective agreements in force resulting from collective bargaining between bona fide trade unions and employers or its representative organisation, as a percentage of employees (in thousands) with the right to collectively bargain and covered by the national legislation on collective bargaining, estimated as follows: $\text{AdjCov_CB} = \text{Cov_CB} / \text{SALRCB} \times 100$

- **AdjCov_ExtE**: Adjusted collective bargaining coverage rate resulting from an administrative extension of any kind of existing collective agreement in force (or a functional equivalent).

Number of employees (in thousands) covered by an administrative extension of any kind of existing collective agreement in force (or a functional equivalent), as a percentage of employees (in thousands) with the right to collectively bargain and covered by the national legislation on collective bargaining, estimated as follows: $\text{AdjCov_ExtE} = \text{Cov_ExtE} / \text{SALRCB} \times 100$